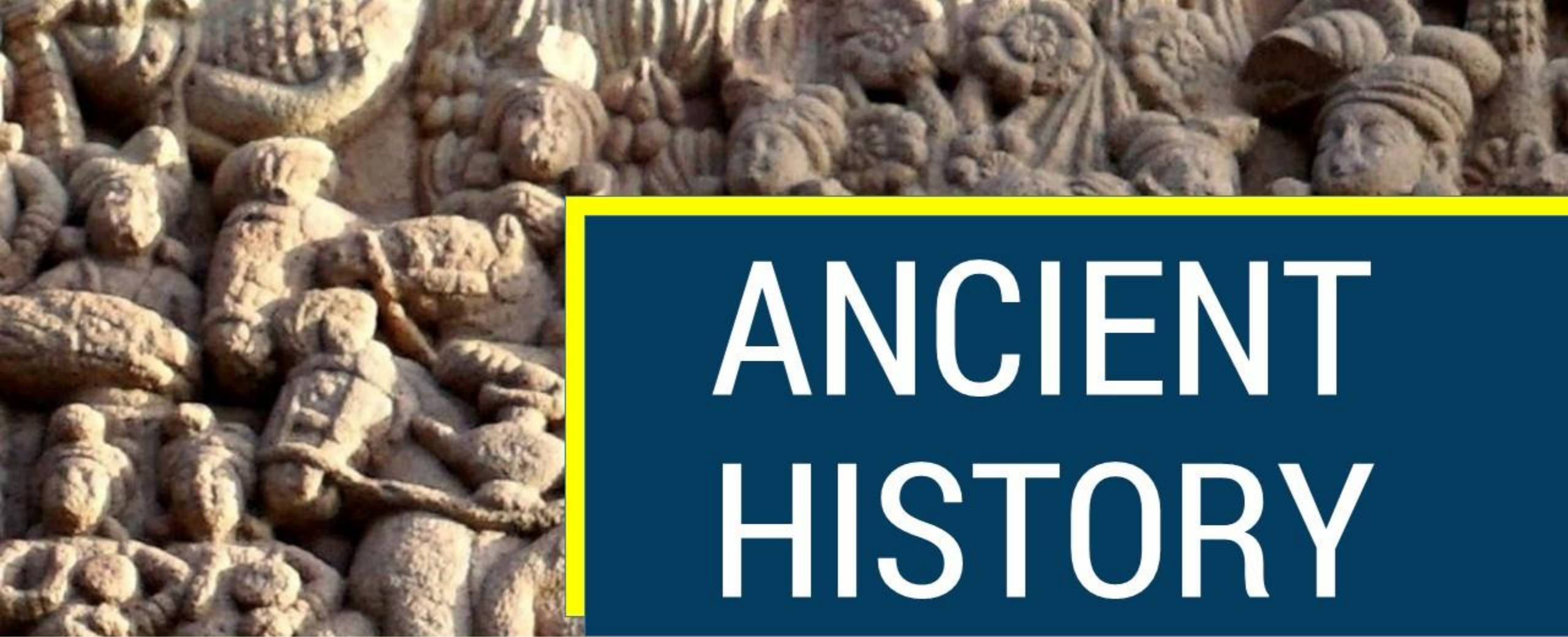




MODULE - 4

PRE - HISTORY
MESOLITHIC ERA

OUR APPROACH TO FIND HISTORY FROM MYSTERY?

PRE - HISTORY

PROTO - HISTORY

HISTORIC PERIOD

The period of time before written records.

- Stone Age
- Metal Age

IVC

Aryan Invasion

VEDIC AGE
(1500 – 500 B.C.)

EARLY VEDIC AGE
(1500 – 1000 B.C.)

LATER VEDIC AGE
(1000 – 500 B.C.)

MAHAJANAPADAS

TERRITORIAL EXPANSION

MAGADHA

NANDA DYNASTY

Alexander Invasion

MAURYAN DYNASTY

SANGAM AGE

MAURYAN DYNASTY

GUPTA DYNASTY

Foreign Invasion

KUSHAN EMPIRE

SATAVAHANAS

PUSHYABHUTHI DYNASTY

Huns Invasion

CHALUKYAS

PALLAVAS

RELIGION & PHILOSOPHY



JAINISM



BUDDHISM

CHOLA

CHERA

PANDYA

MAUKHARIS

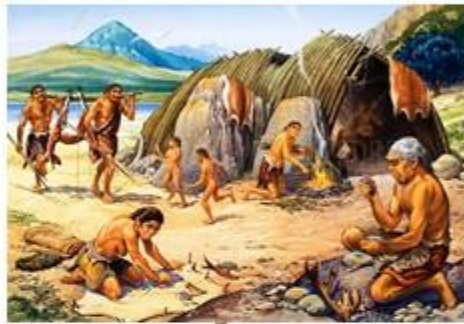
VAKATAKAS

KADAMBAS

PRE- HISTORY

PRE HISTORY

STONE AGE



METAL AGE



PALAEOLITHIC

(5,00,000-10,000 BC)

MESOLITHIC

(10,000-6000 BC)

NEOLITHIC

(6000-1000 BC)

CHALCOLITHIC / COPPER AGE

(3000-500 BC)

BRONZE AGE

(3300-1300 BC)

IRON AGE

(1500-500 BC)

1

SOCIAL

2

ECONOMIC

3

TOOLS

4

SITES

PRE- HISTORY

MESOLITHIC ERA OR MIDDLE STONE AGE

(10000 BC TO 6000 BC)

SOCIAL LIFE

1 SOCIO-ENVIRONMENTAL CONDITIONS



PLEISTOCENE



HOLOCENE

Transition from **Palaeolithic period** to **Mesolithic period** is marked by transition from *Pleistocene period* to *Holocene period*.

Climate became warmer and humid. It became more favourable.

There was expansion of flora and fauna with increased rainfall.

This led to availability of new resources to humans

PRE- HISTORY

MESOLITHIC ERA OR MIDDLE STONE AGE

(10000 BC TO 6000 BC)

SOCIAL LIFE

2 SETTLEMENTS



Nomadism to Sedentary settlements

Favourable climate, better rainfalls, warm atmosphere and increased food security led to reduction in nomadism and led sedentary settlement with increased population.



Sedentary settlements favoured horticulture and primitive cultivation, domestication of animals.



First human colonization of Ganga plains took place during this period.

MESOLITHIC ERA OR MIDDLE STONE AGE

(10000 BC TO 6000 BC)

SOCIAL LIFE

3 ART



Petroglyph is an image carved, incised or scratched into stone



Pictograph is a painting on stone, using natural pigments.

1 In the Mesolithic era, rock art became **more evident** and **new variations** can be seen in use of colours and form of art.

2 These Rock arts are paintings {**pictographs**} and engravings {**petroglyphs**} done in rock shelters or natural caves.

3 Mesolithic man was a **lover of art**, evident from paintings of **Bhimbetka** found in both inhabited and uninhabited shelters.

PRE- HISTORY

MESOLITHIC ERA OR MIDDLE STONE AGE

(10000 BC TO 6000 BC)

SOCIAL LIFE

3 ART

- 4 The paintings are made mostly in red and white pigments.



- 5 Subject matter were mostly wild animals and hunting scenes, or human social and religious life such as sex and child birth.

- 6 In earlier paintings, animal were shown bigger than humans, which shows that humans were intimidated by animals. But later humans were shown as dominant, indicating that humans are more powerful and stronger than animals.

PRE- HISTORY

MESOLITHIC ERA OR MIDDLE STONE AGE

(10000 BC TO 6000 BC)

SOCIAL LIFE

4 BURIAL PRACTICES



- 1 First evidence of **intentional disposal** of the dead comes from Mesolithic Era due to sedentary life.
- 2 Human burials have been found at **Bagor in Rajasthan, Langhnaj in Gujarat, Bhimbetka in MP** etc.
- 3 Dead were occasionally provided with **grave offerings** which include chunks of meat or ornaments.

PRE- HISTORY

MESOLITHIC ERA OR MIDDLE STONE AGE

(10000 BC TO 6000 BC)

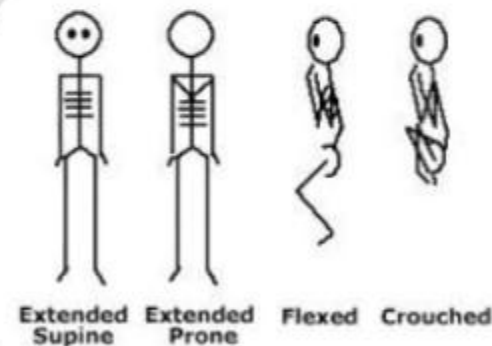
SOCIAL LIFE

4 BURIAL PRACTICES

- 4 In some cases **two individuals** were buried in a single grave.



- 5 Dead were buried in graves both in **extended and crouched position**. {in crouched position knees are bent and the upper body is brought forward and down}.

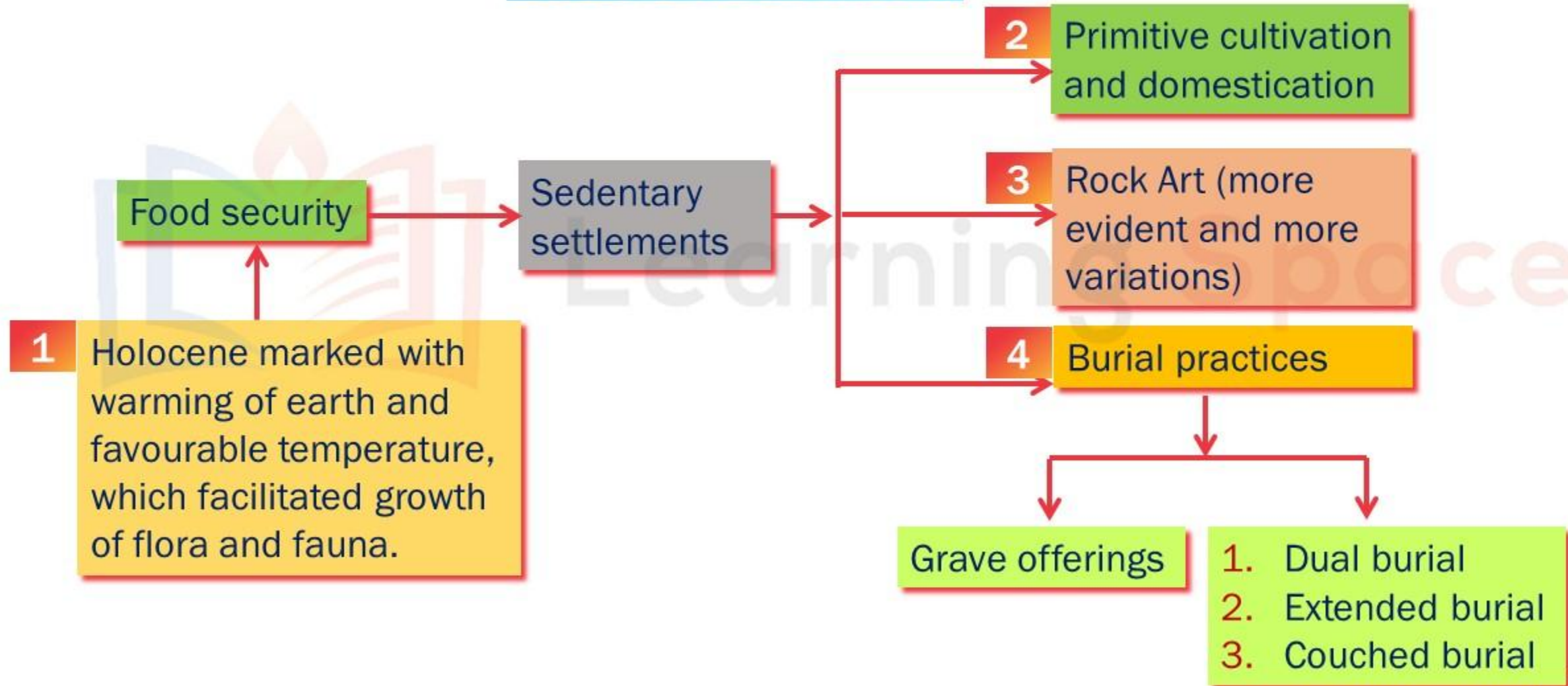


PRE- HISTORY

MESOLITHIC ERA OR MIDDLE STONE AGE

(10000 BC TO 6000 BC)

SOCIAL LIFE- IN SHORT



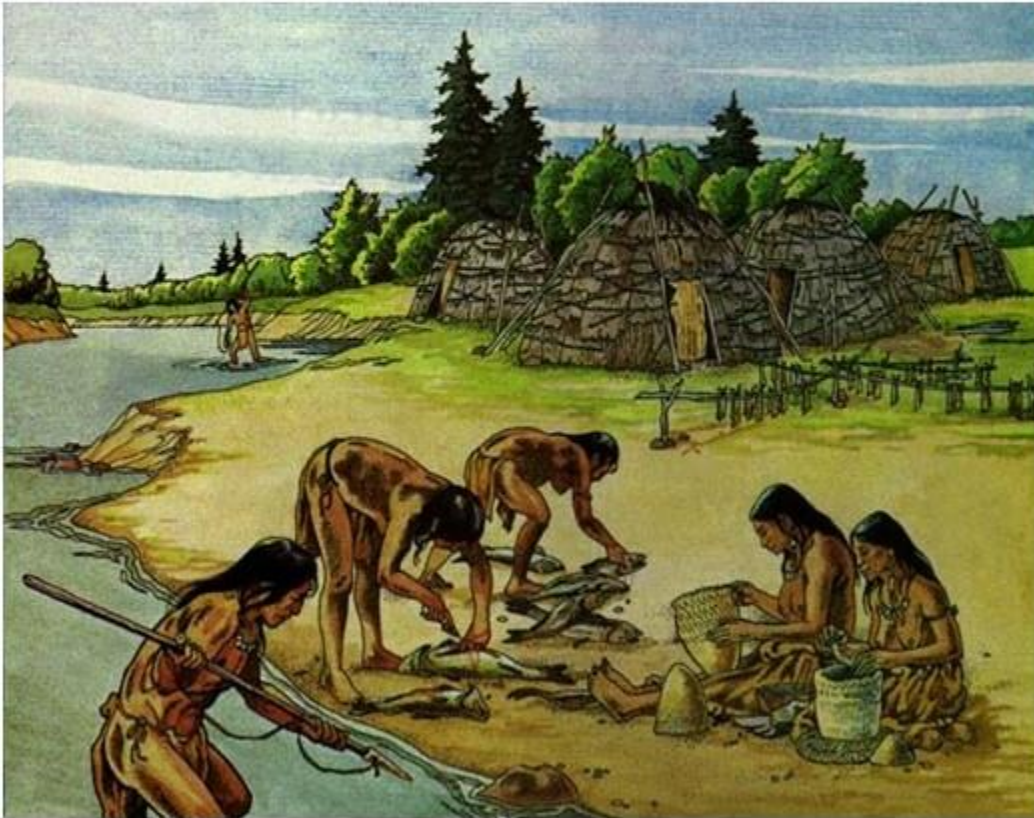
PRE- HISTORY

MESOLITHIC ERA OR MIDDLE STONE AGE

(10000 BC TO 6000 BC)

ECONOMIC LIFE

1 UNDEVELOPED CULTIVATION



Predominantly based on hunting, fishing and food gathering.

↓
Shift from **big animal** hunting to **small animal** hunting

↓
Last phase of this age saw the beginning of **plant cultivation**.

↓
Early men started practicing primitive agriculture. (**slash and burn**)

PRE- HISTORY

MESOLITHIC ERA OR MIDDLE STONE AGE

(10000 BC TO 6000 BC)

ECONOMIC LIFE

1 UNDEVELOPED CULTIVATION

Earliest cultivation, around 7000-6000 BC found near

1. Sambhar lake in Ajmer Rajasthan,
2. Mehrgarh in Pakistan.

First plants to be cultivated was wheat and barley but agriculture had not fully developed.



WHEAT



BARLEY

MESOLITHIC ERA OR MIDDLE STONE AGE

(10000 BC TO 6000 BC)

ECONOMIC LIFE

2 DOMESTICATION

Domestication of Animals.

1. Earliest evidence at:-

- Adamgarh in Madhya Pradesh and
- Bagor in Rajasthan.



2. Domesticated animals proved to be useful not only for meat but also for milk, agricultural operations, and transport.

3. First animals to be domesticated-->dog, cattle, sheep, pig and goat.



PRE- HISTORY

MESOLITHIC ERA OR MIDDLE STONE AGE

(10000 BC TO 6000 BC)

TOOLS

1 MICROLITHS



Mesolithic tools were **smaller in size, polished and better in finishing** than the Palaeolithic age (rough, big, crude, unpolished) and are tiny in shape called ***Microliths***.



PRE- HISTORY

MESOLITHIC ERA OR MIDDLE STONE AGE

(10000 BC TO 6000 BC)

TOOLS

1 MICROLITHS



Some microliths were used as components of spearheads, arrow-heads, knives, sickles, harpoons and daggers.



PRE- HISTORY

MESOLITHIC ERA OR MIDDLE STONE AGE

(10000 BC TO 6000 BC)

TOOLS

2 SHAPED TOOLS



A blade section which has an **oblique truncation** at one end and a perpendicular snapping at the other, which makes cutting operation easy and fast.

TRUNCATED BLADE



Backed blade: a small blade with one edge **blunted** and other edge **sharp**. The blunted section gives enough grip to hold.

BACKED BLADE

Shaped tool like **backed blades**, **obliquely truncated blades**, **points**, **crescents**, triangles and trapezes.



TRAPEZE



CRESCENTS

PRE- HISTORY

MESOLITHIC ERA OR MIDDLE STONE AGE

(10000 BC TO 6000 BC)

TOOLS

3

OTHER TOOLS



- Querns - stone tools for hand - grinding a wide variety of materials.
- These are paired stones used together.

1

New tools like shallow querns and **grinding stones** also occur at several sites. This led to enhanced **efficiency** in **hunting, collection and processing** of wild plant foods.



GRINDING STONE

PRE- HISTORY

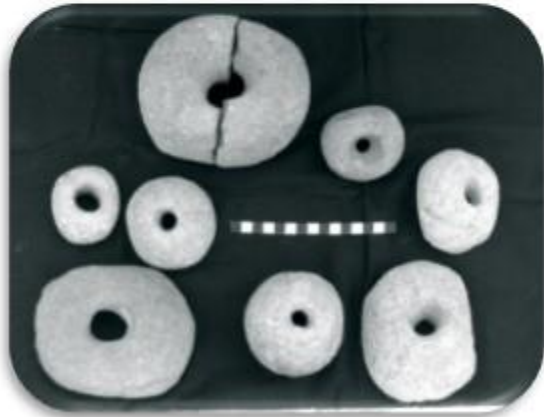
MESOLITHIC ERA OR MIDDLE STONE AGE

(10000 BC TO 6000 BC)

TOOLS

3 OTHER TOOLS

2 **Bored stones**, which already appeared during upper Palaeolithic, became common during this period.

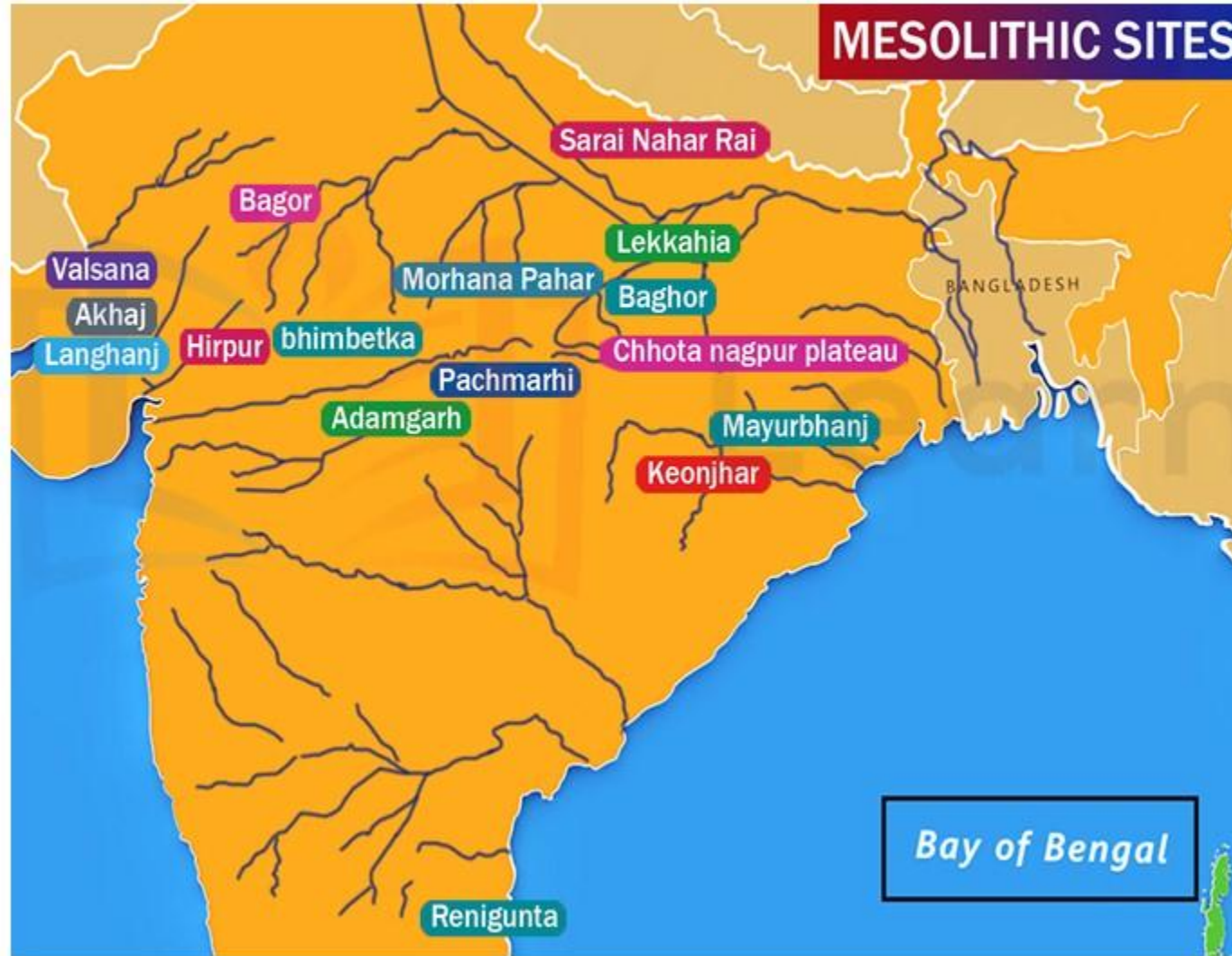


3 Use of **bow and arrows** for hunting.



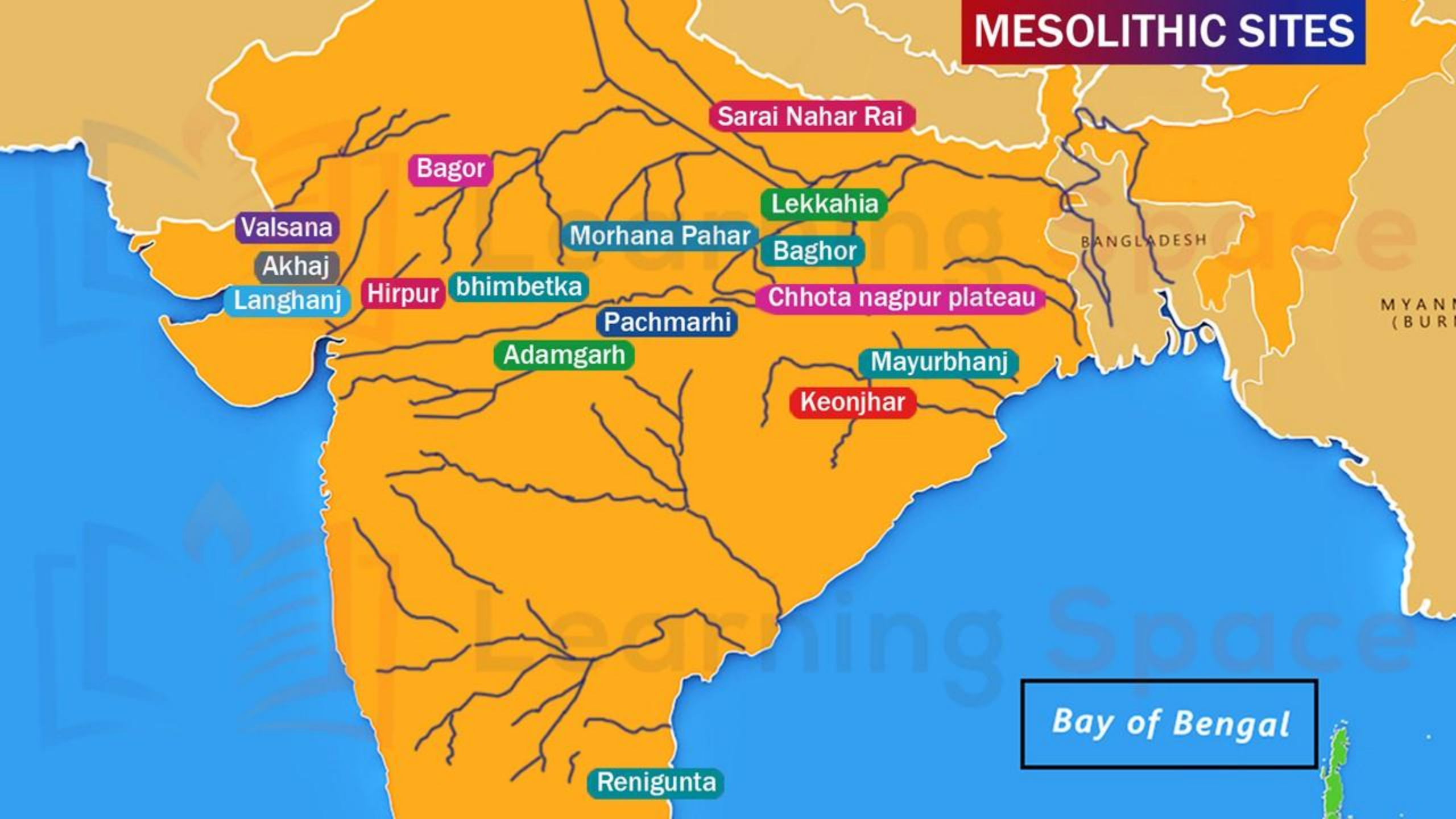
PRE- HISTORY

MESOLITHIC SITES



STATES	MESOLITHIC SITES
Rajasthan	Bagor
Gujarat	On banks of river Sabarmati such as Akhaj, Valsana, Hirpur, Langhanj etc.
Uttar Pradesh	Sarai Nahar Rai, Morhana Pahar and Lekkahia.
Jharkhand	Chhota nagpur plateau
Odisha	Mayurbhanj, Keonjhar, Sundergarh
South India	Karnataka, Tamil Nadu and Andhra Pradesh.

MESOLITHIC SITES



Sarai Nahar Rai

Bagor

Valsana

Akhaj

Langhanj

Hirpur

bhimbetka

Morhana Pahar

Pachmarhi

Adamgarh

Lekkahia

Baghor

Chhota nagpur plateau

Mayurbhanj

Keonjhar

Renigunta

BANGLADESH

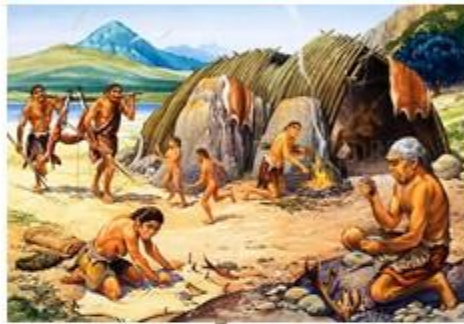
MYANMAR
(BURMA)

Bay of Bengal

PRE- HISTORY

PRE HISTORY

STONE AGE



METAL AGE



PALAEOLITHIC

(5,00,000-10,000 BC)

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(1500-500 BC)

1

SOCIAL

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SITES

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